2026 Q1
Way forward Plan



Problem Statement

Google Maps is deeply embedded in everyday life.
Yet most people still open it only in moments of confusion,
when they are lost, late, or unsure of directions.

It is rarely seen as a companion that helps people choose
better experiences before they even begin the journey.

Objective

Position Google Maps as a real life companion
than just a problem solving tool

Creative Approach

#1

In 2026, “More” isn’t about having more places.
It’s about finding the right place for **your vibe, your moment, and your mood in the chaos of city life.**

In a city full of options, people often default to the same familiar spots. Not because they want to, but because trying somewhere new feels uncertain.

Google Maps removes that uncertainty, helping you discover the right place for exactly the moment you’re in.

By giving people real context, live insights, and multiple ways to explore within the city, it helps them confidently step
beyond the obvious and discover places that align with who they are in that moment.

Because the world has many versions of the same place, and **Google Maps helps you find the one that fits you best.**


More to
the World with
Google Maps

Where Do We Fit In?

Gen Z doesn't want generic recommendations, they want experiences that match their mood and intentions. By surfacing real-time local insights like reviews, photos, and busy hours, Google Maps empowers them to choose with confidence and adapt their plans on the go.

Google Maps helps Gen Z unlock:

1. More versions of the same place:

- Crowded vs quiet
- Peak vs off-peak
- Budget vs indulgent
- Casual hangout vs special night out

2. More context before commitment:

- Recent reviews
- Busy hours
- Street View
- Transit options
- Search along route

3. More recovery when things go wrong:

- Nearby alternatives
- Live traffic
- Plan B

Sample Hero Script

There’s More to Delhi. For Every Version of You.

We collaborate with a Delhi-based creator who takes us through the city, not through typical stereotypes, but through the different moods they experience across the week. Each moment reveals a different side of the city, showing how places can align with who you are on that particular day.



Sample Flow:

Video opens with the creator on a Monday morning version of themselves.
Low energy. Hair tied. Coffee in hand.

"I'm not the same person on Monday morning as I am on Friday night.
So why should I experience the same version of Delhi every day?"

"There's more to Delhi.For whoever you are throughout the week.
And I'm going to show you using Google Maps."

Monday Morning- Quiet Delhi(we see day and time stamps)
"It's Monday Morning. I want to start the week with peace and intention."

Searches Cafés near me
Checks Popular Times to avoid rush
Scans reviews for "peaceful"

Visual: slow coffee morning.

Wednesday Evening- Going out on a budget

“We’re halfway through the week, I wanna go out but also keep my bank balance happy.”

Searches: Affordable restaurants near me
Sorts by rating. Scans recent reviews.
Checks menu photos.
Checks transit- sees traffic

Visual: Takes metro instead to save time. (show metro routes in Maps UI)

Friday Night- Weekend going out vibes

"We survived another week, gotta celebrate. We're going out tonight!"

Searches: Rooftop bars in Delhi
Filters by rating. Checks Busy timings.
Scans reviews for "bollywood music"

Visual: Rooftop bar DJ, dancing, high-energy night.

The video ends with the creator saying "There's more to Delhi. For every version of you."
//
"There's more to Delhi. Depends on who you are today."

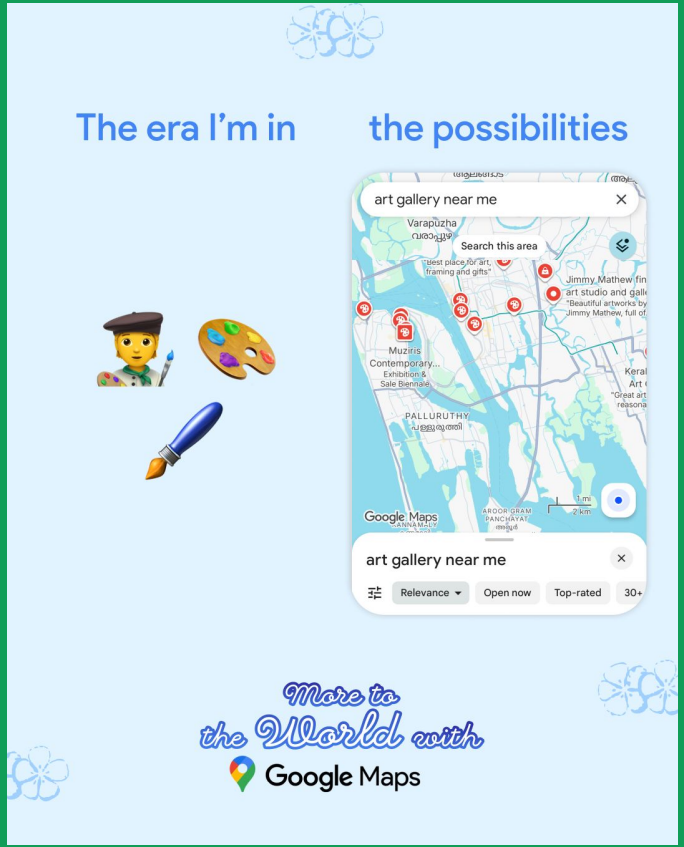
Social Media

Insight:
Gen Z doesn't identify with one fixed personality.
They shift between moods, aesthetics and energies, sometimes within the same day. When they step out, they're not just choosing a place.
They're choosing a version of themselves.

Concept:
A carousel that matches Vibes to Versions of the City. Each slide is split into two columns:

Left Column:
A relatable vibe label that captures a distinct mood or persona (e.g., Artsy, Soft Girl, Broke but Social, Boho, Matcha Lover), paired with an "In my ... era" line represented through a curated set of emojis that visually convey the theme.

Right Column:
Google Maps UI showing real options that match that mood
– Art galleries
– Rooftop bars
– Budget cafés
– Bookstores
– Late-night food spots



Social Leg
Vibe Match

Extension (brand banter):
This format can be extended into brand collaborations, where each slide highlights a specific “era-led” vibe on the left (e.g., “In my fitness era” accompanied by relevant emojis) and “My Go-To Spots” on the right. The right panel features the Google Maps UI, surfacing relevant brands and locations (for example, Project Hum, Subway, and Gold's Gym).

Note: The Google Maps UI will remain unchanged and will display specific locations as they appear within the platform.
Each slide highlights a different brand as a mapped stop within that era, effectively turning the carousel into a curated, discoverable list of vibe-specific go-to places.

Creator Extension
Vibe Swap

Insight:

People experience cities differently based on who they are. An introvert's Delhi can feel completely different from an extrovert's Delhi, just as a luxury seeker experiences the city differently from a budget explorer.

When someone steps into another person's version of the city, it reveals how the same place can offer entirely different experiences. For Gen Z, this contrast is inherently engaging, personality swaps, social experiments, and POV-style content make it entertaining to see people step outside their comfort zones.



Creator Extension
Vibe Swap

Concept:
Two creators. Opposite vibes. One day to swap.

In this content piece, creators exchange personalities for a day and use Google Maps to plan experiences based on the other person's vibe.

A quiet creator plans a high-energy night out.
A fitness creator plans a full day of eating out.
A budget creator visits indulgent spots.
A party person plans a soft, slow reset.

Google Maps becomes the tool that enables them to step into a completely different version of the same city; through search, reviews, peak times, transit and nearby alternatives. The episode closes with both creators reacting to their swapped day: rating how well the other embodied their vibe and what they loved about this swap, thanks to Google Maps.



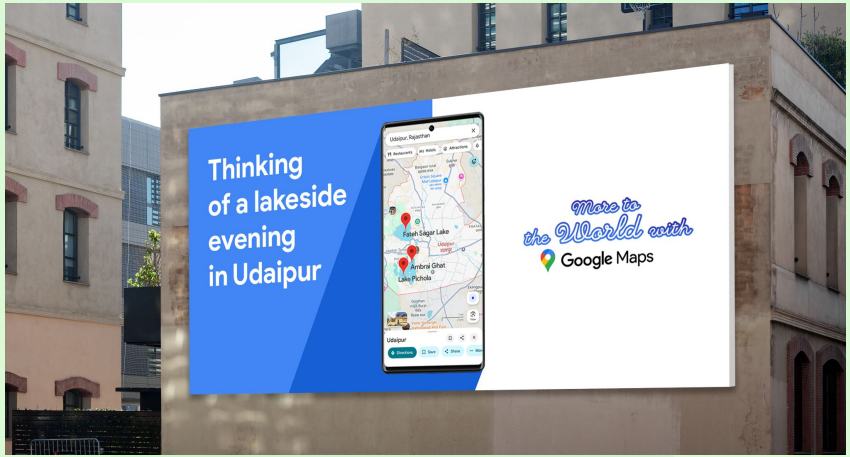
Surround - OOH (Route 1)

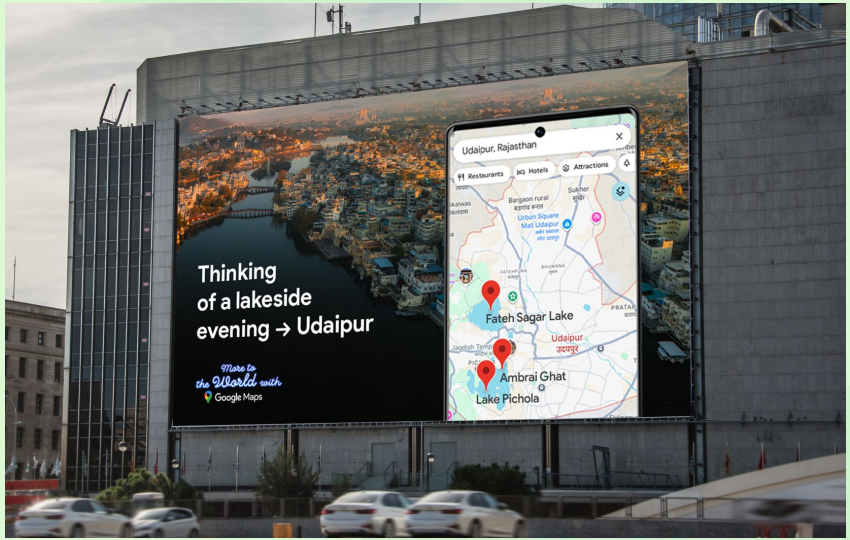
Idea:

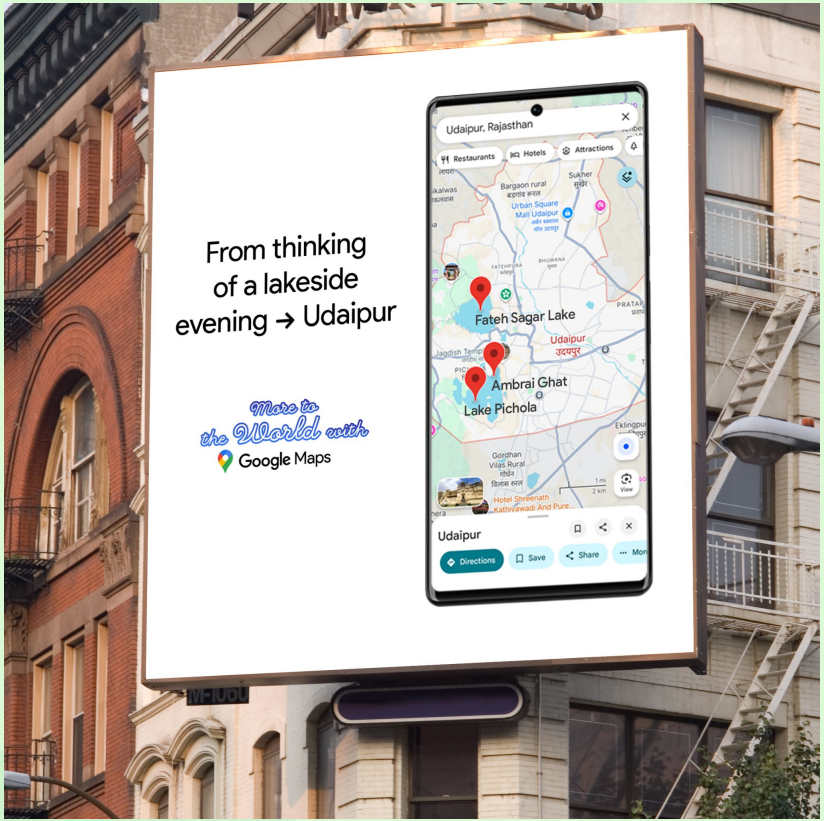
Sometimes destinations pop into our minds out of nowhere, a lakeside view in Udaipur, the French-style streets of Pondicherry, or a quiet mountain café somewhere far away.

These places live in our imagination, but they’re often difficult to search for because we don’t always know their exact names or locations.

We tap into these spontaneous travel thoughts and show how they can easily be discovered through Google Maps. The OOH visuals will showcase these dreamlike destinations directly on a map, with pins highlighting the exact locations people can explore.


Thinking
of a lakeside
evening
in Udaipur
Fateh Sagar Lake
Ambrai Ghat
Lake Pichola
Udaipur
More to
the World with
Google Maps


Thinking
of a lakeside
evening → Udaipur
More to
the World with
Google Maps
Udaipur, Rajasthan
Restaurants
Hotels
Attractions
Fateh Sagar Lake
Udaipur
Ambrai Ghat
Lake Pichola


From thinking
of a lakeside
evening → Udaipur
More to
the World with
Google Maps
Udaipur, Rajasthan
Restaurants
Hotels
Attractions
Fateh Sagar Lake
Udaipur
Ambrai Ghat
Lake Pichola
Udaipur
Directions
Save
Share

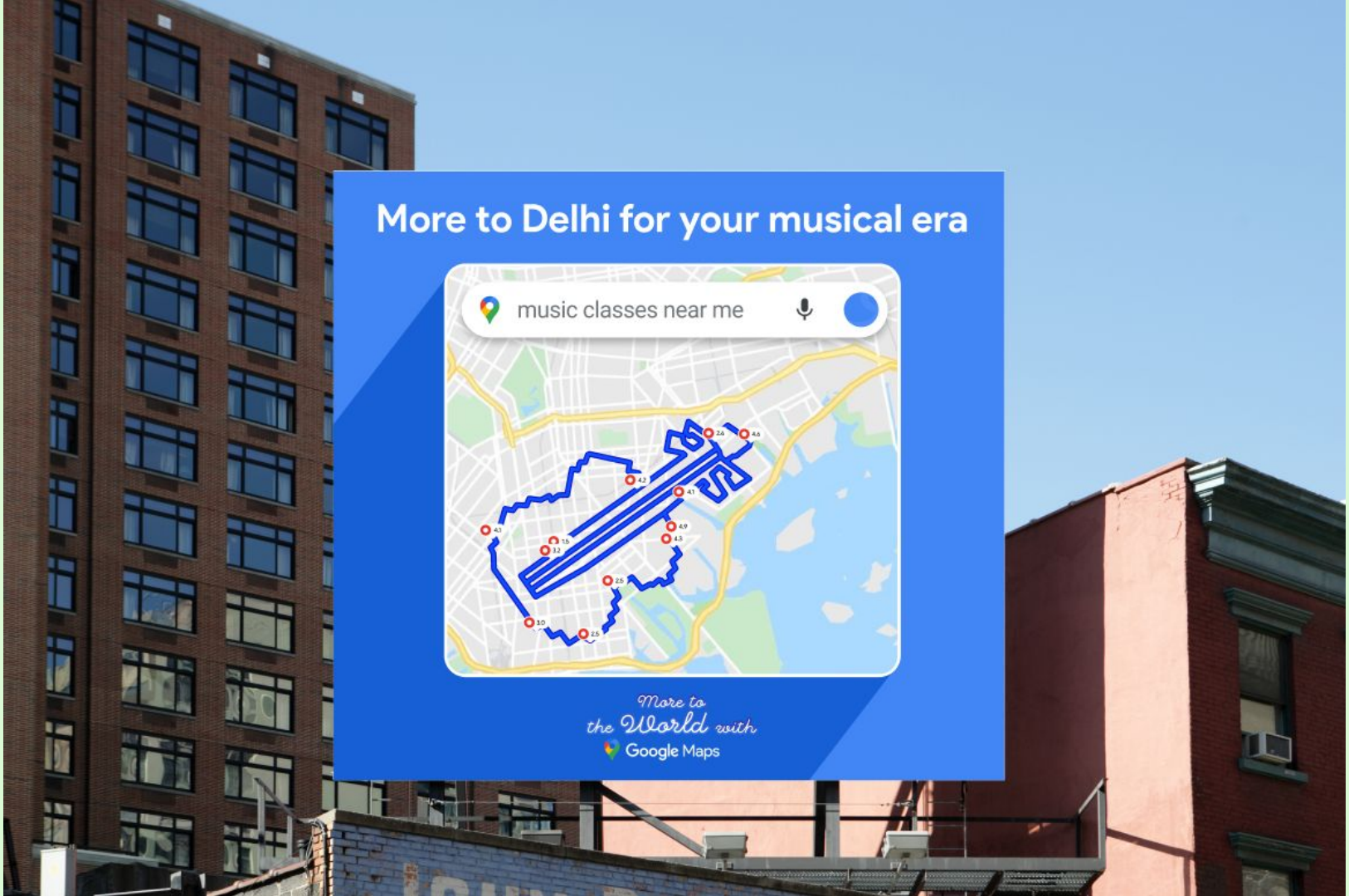
Surround OOH (Route 2)

Idea:
Cities are more layered than people realize. Beyond the well-known spots, every city holds places that match different moods and interests, spaces for music, hidden culinary gems, creative corners, and experiences that reflect your vibe.

The OOH visuals will depict a **Google Maps map filled with expressive pins** that represent different passions and interests.
For example:

- A **paintbrush pin** for creative spaces
- A **pan or fork pin** for different cuisines
- A **guitar pin** for music and live performances

These visual cues show how the map becomes a discovery tool for experiences that match who you are. There's more around you than you think, more flavours, more creativity, more moments waiting to be discovered.


More to Delhi for your musical era
music classes near me
More to
the World with
Google Maps

Partnerships

Great Discoveries 🤝 Great People

Insight:
When people search “best places near me,” they’re not just looking for food.
They’re looking for:

- The right vibe
- The right crowd
- The right experience

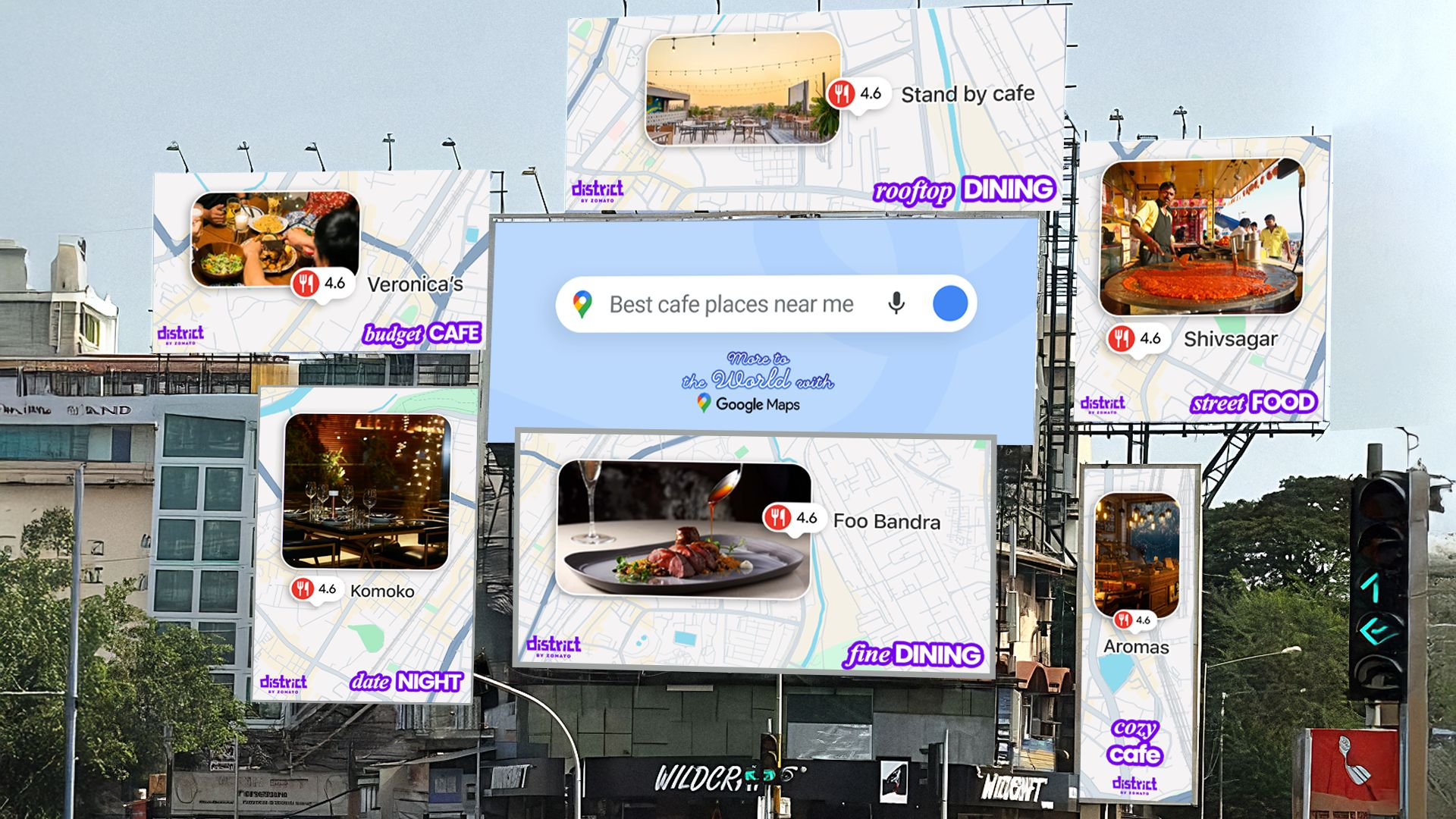
Great discoveries often happen because of great recommendations. And today, those recommendations live on Google Maps. Discovery is no longer random.It’s guided.

Concept:
A brand partnership between Google Maps and District that turns outdoor media into a live discovery experience.The cluster visually feels like a live Google Maps result page brought into the real world. Google Maps connects you to the right places. District connects you to the right people. Together, they power great discoveries.
Note: We can collaborate with more brands here through District, for example, McDonald’s and Starbucks.

Visual:
We create a **cluster billboard installation.** At the center: A large billboard designed like a Google search bar. Text inside:
“Best cafe places near me”

Around it:
Multiple surrounding billboards showing Google Maps UI screens, each surrounding board represents a different vibe:

- Rooftop dining
- Budget café
- Fine dining
- Street food
- Date night


4.6
Stand by cafe
district
rooftop DINING
4.6
Veronica's
district
budget CAFE
Best cafe places near me
More to the World with Google Maps
4.6
Shivsagar
district
street FOOD
4.6
Komoko
district
date NIGHT
4.6
Foo Bandra
district
fine DINING
4.6
Aromas
cozy cafe
district

Always On - Creators

Verified by Google Maps

Insight:
Gen Z doesn’t just try random places anymore. They check reviews first.They look at photos.They see what other people are recommending. They want to feel sure before they go.They don’t want to waste time, money, or a good outfit on a bad place.



Verified by Google Maps

Concept:
Tanesho starts a new food vlog page. Before visiting any café or restaurant, she searches for it on Google Maps.
She checks:

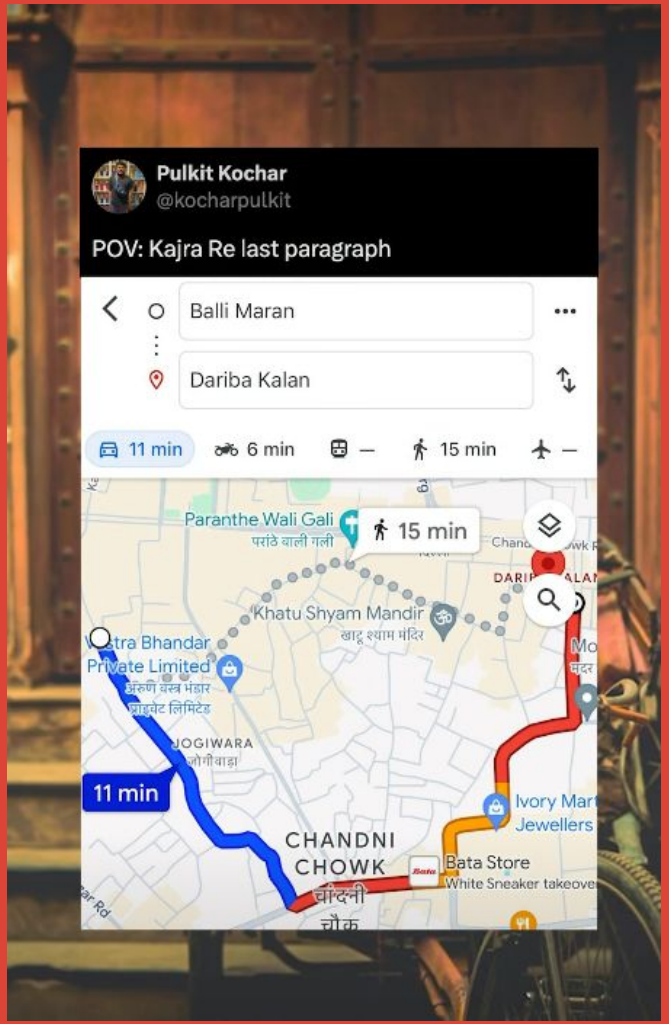
- Reviews
- Ratings
- Photos
- “Best recommended” dishes in the reviews

She orders exactly what people are loving. And she actually loves it too. Through her journey, we see how easy and convenient Google Maps makes discovering good food. It becomes her go-to tool for finding the right places and the right dishes. Google Maps helps her get it right, every time.

Map The Song

Insight:
Music is everywhere in culture, but copyright often limits how creators can use songs directly. At the same time, Gen Z loves decoding references and guessing games online. When clues are subtle and clever, audiences enjoy figuring them out together in the comments.

Concept:
Pulkit creates a fun guessing game where he talks about famous songs without actually playing or naming them, using Google Maps UI locations as clues.
He opens Google Maps and shows places that hint at a popular song, landmarks, cities, streets, or routes connected to the song's lyrics or title.
Pulkit then tells his audience: "Guess which song I'm talking about."



Map The Song

Example flow:
He searches a location on Google Maps that connects to a lyric or theme.
Shows the map, Street View, or route briefly.
Gives a playful hint about the song.
Asks followers to guess the song in the comments.

Through this format, Google Maps becomes the tool that helps decode pop culture through places, turning music into an interactive map-based challenge.

Always On - BAU

#1

Concept:
A lighthearted and relatable reel that captures the dynamic of having that one friend who relies on Google Maps for everything. From deciding where to go, navigating traffic, to choosing what to order, every decision is first run through Maps, making it their ultimate companion for everyday plans.

Visual:
We showcase a day in the life of that one friend, the one who is always on Google Maps. He checks reviews before recommending places .

Copy:
Life when Google Maps is the main quest... and you're just the side quest.

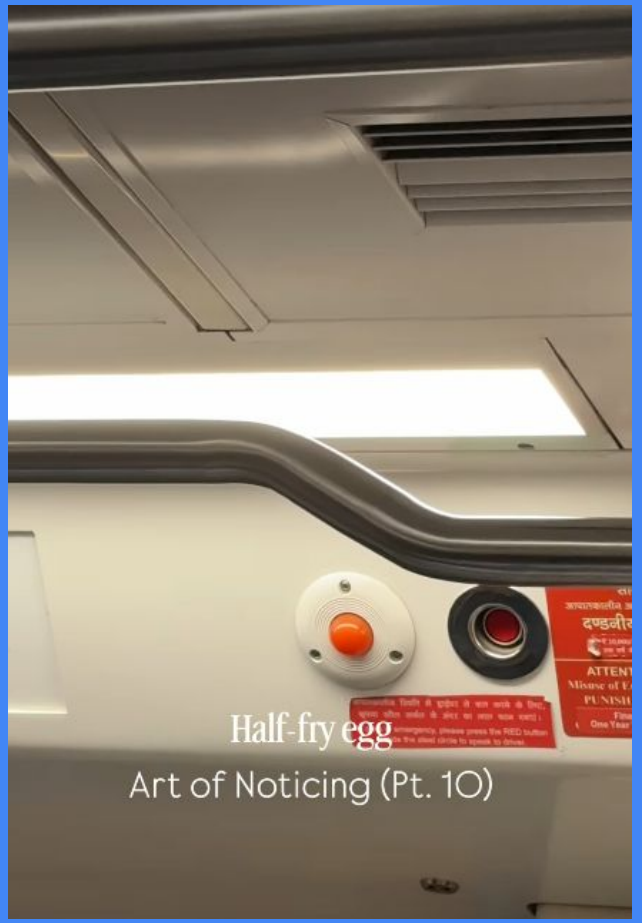


#2

Concept:
Using Google Maps' zoom feature, we show how even from an aerial view, the world is full of tiny, unexpected moments. Also this format has been trending a lot recently, such as "Art of Romanticising life" or "Art of doing nothing" etc. We want to showcase this trend through Google Maps about the fact that it lets you notice more.

Visual:
At first, we see a normal map view. Then we zoom in. And suddenly, there's a story. For example: a cloud shaped like a whale, a traffic signal reflection that looks like a couple, a rooftop shaped like a heart, or two benches facing each other like they're in conversation. We showcase visuals that usually go unnoticed, until we choose to notice them.

Copy:
Art of Noticing.
Ft. Google Maps.



#3

Insight:
Gen Z today is increasingly drawn to hyperlocal exploration. Instead of traditional tourist spots, they enjoy discovering hidden gems within their own cities, whether it's a tucked-away café in Bandra, a quiet sunset point, or a lesser-known street food stall. Social media has amplified this behaviour, with creators constantly sharing niche, insider recommendations that make audiences feel like they've unlocked a secret side of their city.

Concept:
Building on this behaviour, we introduce **Curious Cat**, an IP built around the idea of playful curiosity and local discovery. Much like a curious cat that wanders into unexpected corners, the character explores different neighbourhoods and uncovers hidden gems, sharing them with the audience in an engaging, relatable manner. Over time, Curious Cat has the potential to grow into a recognisable recurring property, similar to iconic digital characters like Vigil Aunty or Agony Aunty, becoming a familiar voice that audiences trust for discovering the most interesting hidden spots around the city.





#3

Format: Carousel
Slide 1:
Visual: A curious cat sitting on top of a parked car on a Bandra street, ready to explore. The cat has a phone with Google Maps open.
Copy
Curious Cat on a quest to find Bandra's hidden spots.

Slide 2:
Visual: Google Maps interface with multiple pins across Bandra. One pin is highlighted on a cozy café lane. The cat is sitting at a small café table with coffee and a croissant while looking at the phone.
Copy:
Major meow-ment.

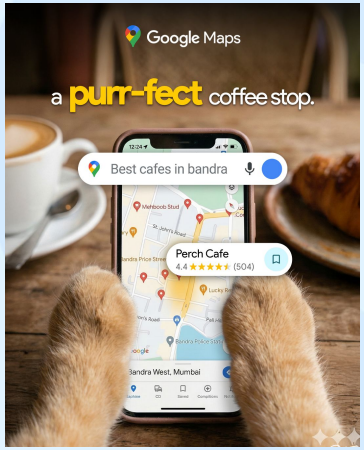
Slide 3:
Visual:
Curious Cat trying on a few jhumkas at a hidden accessories shop on Hill Road.
Copy:
A purr-fect coffee stop.

Slide 4:
Visual:
Curious Cat sitting at Bandra Reclamation, facing the sea and enjoying the sunset view.
Copy:
When the map leads you to the purr-fect sunset spot.

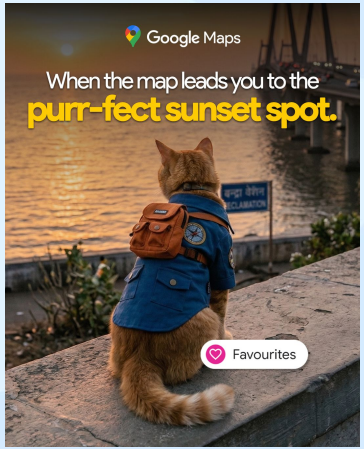
Slide 5:
Curious Cat clicking pictures in Ranwar Village, surrounded by colorful artsy murals.
Copy:
Caught wandering into Bandra's most paw-togenic lanes.
Subtext:
See you next time with more hidden reccos.

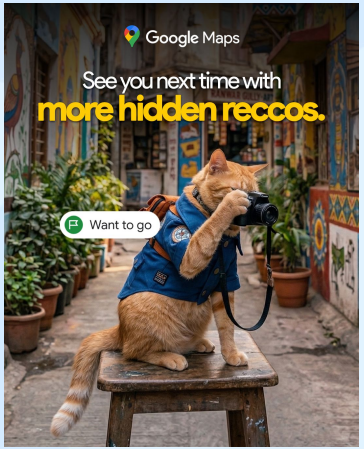
Note:
Every month, we will post either a carousel or a reel where Curious Cat explores different places across cities, discovering hidden gems and sharing recommendations.


Google Maps
अरेस बेज
ARTISAN BAKERY
आरेसन बेकरी
Curious Cat on a quest to find
Bandra's hidden spots.


Google Maps
a purr-fect coffee stop.
Best cafes in bandra
Perch Cafe
Bandra West, Mumbai


Google Maps
Raj Jewellery Shop
Major meow-ment.


Google Maps
When the map leads you to the
purr-fect sunset spot.
Favourites


Google Maps
See you next time with
more hidden reccos.
Want to go

fin.

Overall Inputs

Core Insight: People like their leisure experiences to be an extension of their own self : just the way they want, on their own terms, with no regret potential

How does this translate to behavior ?
GenZ wants their real-world experiences to match their “vibe” at the moment seamlessly, with it fitting their current emotional & mindset needs, and they are willing to go the extra mile to ensure that

(1) Discovering New Places: They explore new places to “break the monotony” or “chase the buzz”, but research enough in advance to know the “reality” to ensure that they do not have a bad experience
(2) Going back to old places: They go back to known places because from past experiences, they know that they place will deliver the experience that they want

How can Google Maps help them ? Help them get the perfect experience they need each time so that they are not left ruining their choice

Research Link

Weekdays & Weekends [40:60]

When you're racing against the clock on weekdays, Google Maps gives you more efficiency.

Search Along the Route helps you grab essentials without detours. Transit integration and multi-modal navigation offer more options when plans change. Street View and EV charging filters provide more confidence to navigate unfamiliar territory.

When you’re looking to discover more on the weekends, Google Maps gives you more options

Trending Nearby and local search reveal more places you've been missing. Place Answers and Review Summaries help you find more experiences beyond the obvious.

Recurring Elements [VLOG FIRST APPROACH]

THE DEFAULT
A familiar behaviour (usual route, usual place, usual plan)

A NEW PLAN[logo + title card]
A roadblock/urge to try something new

THE DISCOVERY
Google Maps shows you more(Search Along Route/Trending Nearby/Reviews)

THE WALKTHROUGH
Visual display of how unknown places/routes become accessible with ease.

THE PAYOFF
Crisis averted/something new tried

THE END[logo + title card]
“More to the World with Google Maps”
Logo unit and/or CTA callout

Creator Approach

To stay always-on while peaking around key moments, content is structured across creators and editorial.

16 posts per quarter

4 Macro Creator films
Exploration-led, activated around cultural moments when people are stepping out and discovering places.

12 Editorial posts
Always-on problem-first content rooted in everyday inefficiencies, showcasing under-used Maps features.

Macro creators drive scale and discovery during big moments while editorial sustains consistency and positions Maps as an everyday companion.